

EVE is DMZ-bound by definition

Why the additive posture is a structural fact, not a promise

Positioning note for the Steel Cloud Solutions – SAP North America lane. Tested against the Hana Europe / EAT HAPPY consolidation brief EgD-HAN-PNL-001.

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The proposition, stated precisely

EVE is a **DMZ-bound** solution. It operates in the zone between the client's managed systems of record and the outside parties who are asked to do work against them. It holds authorized copies, decisions and evidence — never the record itself. Everything that follows from that boundary is additive by construction: it exists to satisfy compliance and to accelerate work that already sits outside the data-management organization's span of control.

Nothing EVE does can subtract, because EVE never holds the original.

Why “DMZ-bound” is a definition, not a claim

A DMZ is a perimeter network placed between an organization's internal network and an external network, exposing only what is intended to be reachable and holding the internal estate behind a second boundary ([NIST CSRC glossary](#); [NIST SP 800-41 Rev. 1](#)). Applied to a consulting and decision-intelligence engagement, three structural facts make the term literal rather than metaphorical.

The three structural facts

01 EVE never receives write authority to a system of record. The canon states that systems of record remain authoritative, that AI-assisted changes enter as proposals, and that a named person approves a specific version ([enterprise-program-alignment/DECISIONS.md](#)). A component with no write path to the ledger cannot be a ledger.

02 What crosses in is an authorized extract, not the estate. The Datasphere model is explicitly a customer-owned, read-only analytical copy with a semantic spine ([eve-datasphere-sovereign/README.md](#)). The client's data organization decides what crosses and keeps the source.

03 The repository, not the session, is the record of what happened in the zone. Decisions, evidence, versions and approvals land as committed files the client owns ([sovereign-starter/SOVEREIGN-STARTER.md](#)). A DMZ with no log is an exposure; a DMZ whose entire content is an append-only log is a control.

What lives in the zone, and what never does

Inside the DMZ (EVE)	Behind the boundary (client-managed, untouched)
Authorized extracts and signed trial balances	ERP ledgers, postings, the general ledger of record
Mapping rules, crosswalks, semantic models	Operational chart of accounts and master data
Decision records, rationale, named approvals	Statutory books, filings, the audited financial statements
Evidence links, validation results, defect register	Local tax and VAT compliance systems
Proposed changes awaiting human authorization	Production configuration, transports, roles and access grants
Consultant working artifacts, versioned	Identity, network, backup, retention and DR operations

Consequence one — additive by construction

Most vendors assert that they are additive. The assertion is only worth what the architecture makes unavoidable. Because EVE holds no original and has no write path, the worst-case failure of an EVE engagement is a discarded copy and a set of documents the client already owns. There is no rollback of a migration, no reprocessing of a ledger, no orphaned integration inside the estate. That is what makes it signable by a client data organization that has been burned before.

- **No displacement.** The incumbent SI, the platform vendor, and the internal data team each keep their scope entirely. EVE consumes their outputs; it does not arbitrate them.
- **No exit cost.** The client keeps the repository whether the engagement continues, pauses, or ends. Removal of EVE removes nothing the client needs.
- **No procurement fight.** A read-only zone under the client's own identity and hosting is a control decision, not a platform decision, and it does not compete for the platform budget.

Consequence two — compliance is the payload, not a feature

The reason to stand up the zone at all is that the work happening outside the managed estate is exactly the work that is hardest to evidence. Auditors examining end-user computing look at provenance, logic, access, change control, versioning and reproducibility (ICAEW, [“The auditor’s review of management spreadsheets”](#)). Those six things are the DMZ’s entire content. A signed mapping, an automated validation, a locked package and a named approver are minimum controls for a workbook-era bridge, and they are what EVE supplies without anyone touching the source ledgers.

The same logic covers the delivery bench. The traditional offshore risk is context drift — the delivery team quietly substituting its own reasoning for the client's. Inside the zone, every artifact is versioned as it is produced and reviewable in the same working session, so review stops being a weekly cadence and becomes a property of the surface.

Consequence three — it accelerates only what is already outside

The acceleration claim is bounded by the same boundary, and that is why it survives scrutiny. EVE speeds up assessment, mapping design, policy documentation, decision capture, close-package preparation and artifact production — work that today happens in inboxes, decks and unversioned workbooks, outside the data organization's control framework and outside its tooling. It does not speed up anything the data organization already runs well, and it does not ask for a change window to do its job.

The line the client's data lead actually hears

"We are not asking for access to your systems, a change to your landscape, or a seat in your change-advisory board. We are asking you to authorize an extract into a zone you own, and in exchange the work your business is already doing outside your control framework becomes evidenced, versioned and reversible — and finishes faster."

What this settles in the Hana brief

The consolidation brief EgD-HAN-PNL-001 delivered an honest verdict: EVE is the lightest governance wrapper but not the lightest complete consolidation solution, and it must not be represented as a consolidation engine. Under the DMZ framing that verdict stops being a limitation and becomes the specification.

- **"Scope mismatch" resolves.** Consolidation requires accounting rules, ownership logic, journals and eliminations. Those are engine functions behind the boundary. Custody, provenance and decision continuity are zone functions. The brief's recommended Option 2 — a thin, controlled trial-balance mapping and evidence layer — is a DMZ pattern described in accounting language.
- **"Implementation weight hides in sovereign" resolves.** Weight enters when a project reaches behind the boundary to replicate transactional detail. The DMZ rule is the test that keeps the first close light: if it requires a write path or a landscape change, it is out of scope for the bridge.
- **"No automatic statutory acceptability" stands and must stand.** A zone that evidences preparation does not certify the result. The reporting parent still owes IFRS 10 consolidation and IFRS 3 acquisition accounting, and the auditor still decides what to rely on.

Where the framing must not be over-claimed

The positioning is strong precisely because it is narrow. Four honest limits keep it defensible in front of a CISO, a data protection officer, or an audit partner.

- **A DMZ is a boundary, not an assurance certificate.** The zone still needs its own access model, segregation of duties, retention rules and logging. Being outside the estate is not the same as being controlled.
- **Copies carry obligations.** Personal data crossing into the zone is still processing under GDPR, and transfers outside the EEA still require an adequacy basis or safeguards ([EDPB international transfers](#)). Classification, minimization of identifiers and a documented transfer assessment are part of standing the zone up, not an afterthought.

- **Read-only is an architecture, not a slogan.** It has to be provable in the connection design and the access grants, or the claim collapses on first review.
- **Additive is not free of supportability risk.** The client must own the runbooks, tests, access and deployment for the zone, or a custom layer becomes a new key-person dependency.

What it does for the GTM lane

For the Steel Cloud Solutions position with SAP North America presales, the DMZ frame is the mechanism underneath the arm's-length posture already published on the [SCS SAP GTM surface](#). It converts three of that page's assertions into structural facts.

- **"Not a reseller, not an SI, not a displacement"** becomes architecturally true rather than contractually promised: a party with no write authority cannot take over anyone's scope.
- **"Own the ground floor, rent whatever you want above it"** gains its floor plan. The custody layer is the DMZ; the vendor stack stays where it is; the estate stays where it is.
- **Protection of the account team's standing** becomes demonstrable. The semantic model stays on ground the customer owns and SAP can reach, and no one has to explain to a security review why a third party holds write access to the ledger.

The additive posture is not restraint. It is the shape of the thing.

Sources and provenance

- [NIST CSRC — demilitarized zone \(DMZ\)](https://csrc.nist.gov/glossary/term/demilitarized_zone) — https://csrc.nist.gov/glossary/term/demilitarized_zone
- [NIST SP 800-41 Rev. 1 — Guidelines on Firewalls and Firewall Policy](https://nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/legacy/sp/nistspecialpublication800-41r1.pdf) — <https://nvlpubs.nist.gov/nistpubs/legacy/sp/nistspecialpublication800-41r1.pdf>
- [ICAEW — The auditor's review of management spreadsheets](https://www.icaew.com/technical/audit-and-assurance/faculty-resources/audit-and-beyond/2024/articles/the-auditors-review-of-management-spreadsheets) — <https://www.icaew.com/technical/audit-and-assurance/faculty-resources/audit-and-beyond/2024/articles/the-auditors-review-of-management-spreadsheets>
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- [Sovereign Starter — boot, canon, defect loop](https://github.com/EVEglyphDesign/sovereign-starter/blob/main/SOVEREIGN-STARTER.md) — <https://github.com/EVEglyphDesign/sovereign-starter/blob/main/SOVEREIGN-STARTER.md>
- [Steel Cloud Solutions — SAP North America additive layer](https://eveglyphdesign.github.io/scs-sap-gtm/) — <https://eveglyphdesign.github.io/scs-sap-gtm/>
- [EVEglyphDesign Executive Boot Contract](https://eveglyphdesign.github.io/eve-glyph-boot-contract/) — <https://eveglyphdesign.github.io/eve-glyph-boot-contract/>

Evidence classification. External definitions and requirements are linked inline. EVE statements are grounded in the committed repository files linked above. The DMZ characterization, its consequences, and the reconciliation with EgD-HAN-PNL-001 are advisory judgments of positioning, not verified facts about any client estate.

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